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Beyerdynamic DT 900 Pro X

An excellent mid-range solution for unaltered listening

Building upon the tremendous success of Beyerdynamic's DT 900 Pro headphones, the Beyerdynamic DT 900 Pro X promises unaltered listening on any device without the need for external amplification. Let's find out how it fared.

BUILD AND FEATURES

The Beyerdynamic feel more luxurious than their cost; right from the plushy velour ear pads to the brushed metal headband, the DT 900 Pro X exudes a premium air. The open-back design means that the cups are well ventilated but this design does allow for leakage and ineffective passive isolation, so it is best to use them in a closed studio.

The build also plastic for the outer covering of the headband and the ear cups, but it doesn't come across as cheap. The usage of some plastic allows the company to keep the weight down to 345g. We would have preferred if the headband's cushion was slightly more voluminous. The memory foam ear cups though were supple and extremely comfortable over the ears.

There's no folding mechanism and the ear cups don't rotate, so these aren't easily portable headphones.

The Beyerdynamic DT 900 Pro X comes packing two swappable 3-pin mini-XLR cables in the box with a 3.5mm jack for your device at the other end. The cables are of different lengths - 3-meter and 1.8-meter. Beyerdynamic also includes a ¼-inch adapter that screws on to the 3.5mm connector, so you can connect the headphones to an audio interface, if needed.

PERFORMANCE

The Beyerdynamic DT 900 Pro X are open-backed studio headphones which means air and sound move freely through the grills on the ear cups, allowing for more natural and open sound. This often comes at the cost of isolation. Sporting a low impedance



of 48 ohms, the Beyerdynamic DT 900 Pro X can be powered by most devices. The headphones come pack Beyerdynamic's STELLAR45 drivers with a frequency response of 5 Hz - 40,000 Hz.

The Beyerdynamic DT 900 Pro X is meant to serve as an unaltered audio playback solution for sound engineers, mixers, and critical listeners, and it does just that. For the uninitiated, the sound can be a bit jarring, because these headphones don't attempt to reproduce sound in a pleasant, enjoyable manner but as it is. So, there are times when you will hear overly harsh high notes, the unpleasant rumbling of low bass, that consumer headphones usually tone down. But all of this is present in all of its glory on the DT 900 Pro X because its job isn't to shelter you from unpleasant frequencies but to give you an honest, clear representation of sound.

The result? You will hear details in tracks that you've never really experienced before on consumer-grade headphones. In songs such as *Pull Me Under* by *Dream Theatre*, you can hear every guitar pluck or drum hit to perfection - and sometimes, you can even catch mistakes on old recordings. It really

lends a hand in allowing musicians and mixers to create the best-sounding track possible. Of course, higher range studio headphones produce this unaltered sound with slightly more precision and a wider soundstage. The soundstage on these headphones is quite limiting which may bring out some inaccuracies in imaging. However, for the price, these are natural-sounding studio headphones that can be driven by most devices you own.



VERDICT

The primary difference between the Beyerdynamic DT 900 Pro X and the original DT 900 Pros is that the former brings with it improved comfort, replaceable parts, and reduced impedance. If these

features aren't vital to you, it would be prudent to buy the DT 900 Pro instead and save over ₹15K of your hard-earned money. However, if these features make a difference, then what you're getting for the price is a clean and natural-sounding pair of studio headphones with a robust build and the ability to be driven by most of your devices. It is one of the best mid-range options you can find on the market for sound engineers, mixers, DJs, and musicians. An excellent alternative from the Sennheiser camp is the Sennheiser HD 600 that provides accurate sound reproduction as well.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

TRANSDUCER TYPE: Dynamic | OPERATING PRINCIPLE: Open | HEADPHONE TYPE: Circumaural | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 5 - 40,000 Hz | NOMINAL IMPEDANCE: 48 Ω | LENGTH AND TYPE OF CABLE: 3 m (9.8 ft) / straight cable or 1.8 m (5.9 ft) / straight cable, each detachable, with 3-pin mini XLR cable connector, single-sided | CONNECTION: Gold-plated mini stereo jack (3.5 mm) & ¼" adapter (6.35 mm) | WEIGHT: 345 g

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